

— A FREE LOST CHAPTER —

ZARA AND THE DIVINE SIGNAL

The Night Before

A scene that never made it into the book – until now.



by Vishal Hingol

A FREE LOST CHAPTER

ZARA AND THE DIVINE SIGNAL

The Night Before

A scene that never made it into the book – until now.

by Vishal Hingol

A NOTE BEFORE YOU BEGIN

This chapter does not appear in *Zara and the Divine Signal*. It happens the night before the book begins – before Zara has any idea what is about to be asked of her.

You do not need to have read the book to read this. It stands completely on its own. But if you have read the book, you will recognise something in this chapter that the book never explained – and now you will know.

This is our gift to you for joining us. We hope it's the beginning of something.



THE NIGHT BEFORE

Zara and the Divine Signal

A Lost Chapter



Zara was eleven years old, and she could not sleep, and she did not yet know that this was the last ordinary night of her life.

She lay on her back with her eyes open in the dark, listening to the house settle the way it always settled at this hour – the small groan of the water heater two floors down, the specific creak of the third stair that her brother always forgot to avoid, the wind doing something halfhearted against the window that didn't quite qualify as a storm.

None of this was new. She had lain awake in this exact position, listening to this exact house, more nights than she could count. What was new – what she could not explain to herself, let alone to anyone else – was the feeling underneath the listening.

It felt like waiting for a phone to ring.

Not anxious waiting. Not the kind where your stomach tightens and you check the clock every four minutes. A different kind. The kind where some part of you already knows the call is coming, and the only mystery left is when, and you are simply staying close enough to the phone that you won't miss it.

She did not have a phone yet. Her parents said twelve. This was not about a phone.

She turned onto her side and looked at the wall where the streetlight came through the gap in the curtains and made a long pale stripe across her bookshelf, the way it did every night, the way it had since she was six and had asked her father to move her bed under the window because she liked watching the stripe move as the night went on.

He had moved the bed. He had not asked why. This was one of the things she loved about her father – he treated her strange requests as information rather than as problems. Once, when she was eight, she had asked him to leave the hallway light on but the bedroom door open exactly four inches, no more, no less, and he had measured it with his hand the way carpenters measure things, and never asked why four inches mattered, and it had mattered enormously, though even she could not have said why.

She thought about that now, lying in the dark. The four inches. The specific stripe of light. The countless small arrangements she had made over the years without being able to explain them, that her father had simply trusted were necessary, the way you trust a plant knows which way is up.

She watched the stripe.

And she thought, not for the first time, but more clearly than she had ever let herself think it before: something is going to ask something of me, and I don't know what it is, and I don't know when, but I think I am supposed to say yes.

She did not know where this thought came from. It did not feel like her own thought, exactly – it felt like a thought that had been left somewhere for her to find, the way you find a note in a coat pocket from a season you'd forgotten, written in your own handwriting, about something you no longer remember writing about.

She sat up.

The house around her held its three closed doors – her brother's, her parents', the hall closet that didn't really need a door but had one anyway, a detail of the house she had never questioned until just now, sitting in the dark, noticing things. Three closed doors and a fourth, her own, slightly open, the way she liked it. The way she had always liked it, now that she thought about it. Open enough that the hallway's small light could find her. Open enough that nothing on the other side of it could be entirely unknown to her.

She had built, without realising she was building anything, a house inside the house. A specific arrangement of light and gaps and just-enough-darkness that she had never once described to anyone, because there had never been a reason to. It had simply been what felt right. The way breathing felt right. You didn't explain breathing.

She got up.

She was not the kind of child who got up in the night. She liked rules. She liked the version of herself that fell asleep when she was told to and woke up when the alarm went off and did not wander the house in the dark like the children in books who always seemed to be looking for

trouble, who always found a door that shouldn't open, a staircase that led somewhere it hadn't led the day before.

She was not looking for trouble. She did not know what she was looking for. She only knew that lying still had become, in the last ten minutes, the wrong thing to be doing, and that some other thing was now the right thing, even though she could not have said what the other thing was.

She went to the window.



The street below was empty in the specific way streets are empty at – she checked the clock on her dresser – 2:14 in the morning. Empty not like absence, but like held breath. A streetlamp two houses down flickered, the way it always flickered, an old fault in the wiring that the city had been “looking into” for as long as she could remember. Mrs. Okafor across the street had called about it twice. Nothing had changed. It

was, as far as Zara knew, the single most reliably unreliable thing in the neighbourhood, a small broken metronome keeping a small broken time that nobody but her seemed to notice or mind.

She had always liked it for that. The brokenness. The way it tried and failed and tried again, on, off, on, off, an old machine doing its honest best with a fault nobody had bothered to fix. She had once told her brother this, that she liked the broken streetlamp because it never gave up, and he had looked at her the way her brother looked at most of the things she said, which was to say: like she'd said something slightly too strange to argue with, and slightly too true to laugh at, so he simply changed the subject.

She watched it flicker now.

On, off, on, off, on.

And then it didn't go off.

It held. Steady. Brighter, almost, than she'd ever seen it – not dramatically brighter, not like something from a film, just brighter in the way a single held note is louder than the same note played quickly, the way silence after a long noise is louder than the noise itself. And underneath the held light, in the stillness of the empty street, she felt something she would spend years afterward trying to find the right words for, and would eventually decide there were no right words, only approximate ones.

She felt noticed.

Not by a person. Not by anything she could point to. By the night itself, or by something using the night the way a hand uses a glove – present inside it, moving it, without being the glove.

Her brother's door was closed. Her parents' door was closed. The house held its three closed doors and its one open-eyed child standing at a window in the dark, and none of the closed doors knew anything about what was happening on the other side of the glass.

She did not feel afraid.

This was the part she would return to, later, in the years after everything had changed – the specific absence of fear in a moment that, described to anyone else, would sound like the beginning of a nightmare. An eleven-year-old, alone, at two in the morning, watching a streetlight do something streetlights don't do. Every instinct a worried adult would want her to have – go back to bed, wake your parents, this isn't normal – simply wasn't there. In its place was something that felt, absurdly, like relief. Like the relief of finally hearing the phone ring after an evening of half-expecting it. Like setting down something heavy you'd forgotten you were carrying.

She put her hand on the window glass.

It was warm. Glass in February, at two in the morning, should not have been warm. She kept her hand there anyway, because some part of her understood – without being told, the way she'd understood the bed should go under the window, the way she'd understood her door should be open exactly enough and no more – that warmth was not the strange part. Warmth was the gentle part. Whatever this was, it was being gentle with her on purpose, the way you are gentle with something you don't want to startle. The way her father had been gentle with her strange requests, all those years, without ever needing to understand them first.

I don't know what you are, she thought, not quite forming it into words she could have said aloud. But I think I've been waiting for you longer than I've known I was waiting.

The light held a moment longer.

In that moment, she became aware of something else – not seen, not heard, but felt, the way you feel a held note resolve before it actually resolves, anticipation collapsing into arrival. It was the sensation of a question being asked. Not in words. Not even in anything as defined as a feeling. More like a door, somewhere far inside her, swinging very slowly on a hinge that had never once been used, testing whether it still

remembered how to move.



She did not answer it. Not yet. She would not have known how. But she did not look away, either, and she would understand only much later that not looking away had been its own kind of answer – the only one that mattered, the only one the door on the hinge had been waiting for.

Then, very slowly – not flickering out, not dying, but settling, the way a held breath

finally releases – the light dimmed back to its ordinary unsteady self. On, off, on, off, the old electrical fault the city had been meaning to fix, nothing more, nothing anyone driving past would ever look at twice.

Zara stood at the window for a long time after that, watching an ordinary broken streetlamp do ordinary broken-streetlamp things, and feeling, for the first time in her life, the particular ache of having touched something enormous and then having it let go of her hand first.

She did not go back to sleep easily. She lay back down and watched the stripe of streetlight resume its slow crawl across her bookshelf, and she thought about the four inches of open door, and the bed under the window, and all the small architecture she had built around herself without ever knowing she was building toward something. She thought: maybe I have always been getting ready. Maybe getting ready was the whole first part, and I just didn't have a word for it because nobody needed me to have a word for it yet.

In the morning she would wake up and go to school and eat her cereal and argue with her brother about the bathroom and be, in every visible way, exactly the same girl she had been the day before.

She told no one.

Not because she'd decided to keep a secret. She simply didn't have the sentence for it yet. Something looked at me through a streetlamp is not a sentence a sane eleven-year-old says out loud at breakfast, and Zara, whatever else she was about to become, was not interested in being thought insane. So she carried it. Quietly. The way you carry a stone in your pocket that you picked up for reasons you can't articulate, that you

keep meaning to take out and look at properly, and never quite do, because some part of you already knows that looking at it properly is going to change something, and you are not ready yet for the changing.

She would be ready in eleven days.

She did not know that yet, lying back down in her bed with the stripe of streetlight once again moving slowly across her bookshelf, ordinary, flickering, waiting the way she was waiting, though only one of them knew it.



That is where this story ends.

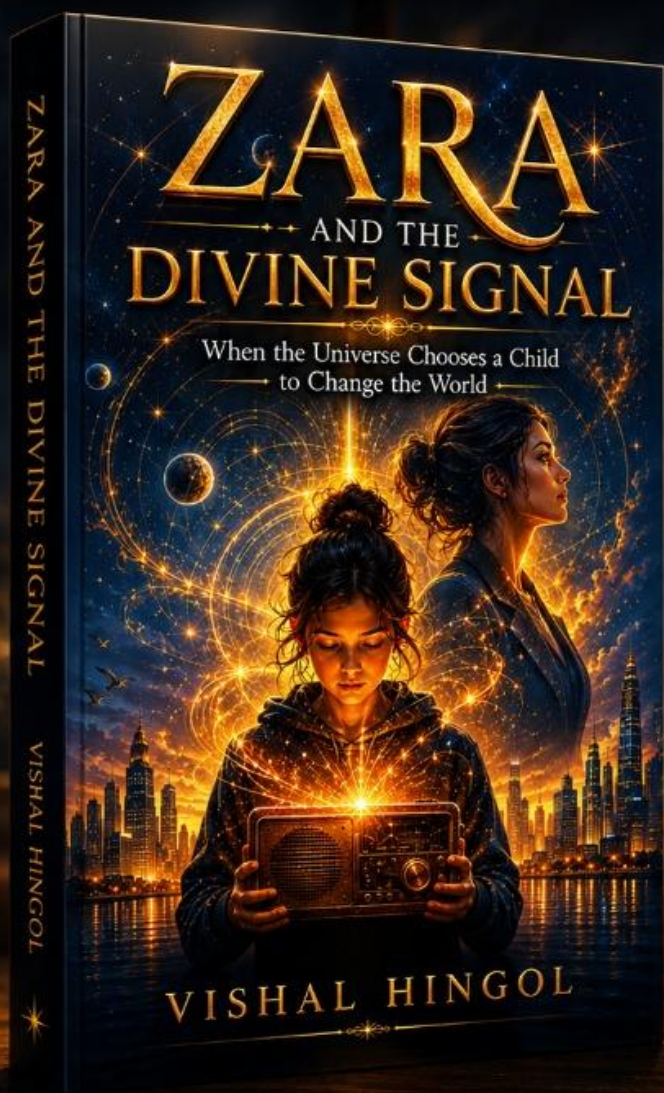
The next part – the part where the waiting stops, where the stone finally gets taken out of the pocket and looked at properly, where an eleven-year-old girl finds out exactly what had been holding its breath on the other side of her bedroom window – is not a part of this chapter.

It is the first page of the book.

CONTINUE THE STORY

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER THAT NIGHT IS THE
ENTIRE BOOK.

ZARA'S JOURNEY IS WAITING FOR YOU.



EVERY SIGNAL
BEGINS BEFORE
YOU KNOW
YOU'RE READY.

GET YOUR COPY ON

amazon

Continue the Story

Zara's full journey is waiting for you

What happens after that night is the entire book. The eleven days. The signal she finally has to face. The choice that no eleven-year-old should have to make – and the one she makes anyway.

If the feeling in this chapter is one you recognised – that sense of having always been quietly getting ready for something you couldn't yet name – the rest of Zara's story is for you.

Get Zara and the Divine Signal on Amazon

And if Zara's story is the kind of book that stays with you, here is the rest of the catalogue – each one a different signal, for a different season of becoming who you actually are:

The Real Frequency of Origins – *When the Universe Starts Talking Back*

The Real Architect of Echoes – *The Story of Changing Your Frequency*

The Real Resonance Threshold – *A Mind-Bending Sci-Fi Thriller of Quantum Consciousness, Frequency, and the Collapse of Reality*

See the Full Catalogue

WORK WITH VISHAL DIRECTLY

Reading helped. Talking it through helps more.

Every insight creates **awareness**.

A real conversation creates **transformation**.

Together, we'll turn what you've learned
into the **life you truly want**.



1 FREE 20-MINUTE INTRO CALL

We talk through where you're
actually stuck. No pitch, no pressure
– just an honest conversation.
If it's not the right fit, that's okay.



2 A PLAN BUILT AROUND YOU

Not a generic program. Your unique
challenges, goals, and strengths
become the foundation of our
mentorship plan.



3 REAL 1:1 ACCOUNTABILITY

Ongoing sessions, honest feedback,
and progress tracking to keep you
moving forward – with clarity and
consistent support.

What You Can Expect



Clarity on Your
Next Right Step



Break Through
Mental Blocks



Practical Strategies
That Work



Stay Focused &
Consistent



Real, Lasting
Change



Live With Purpose
& Confidence

“ You don't need more information.
You need the right guidance
at the right time.

If you've read the books and you're
ready for the next step, I'd like to hear from you.



BOOK YOUR FREE INTRO CALL

✓ No Obligation

✓ Confidential

✓ Personalized

✓ 100% Focused On You

Thank you for reading – and for staying connected.

– Vishal Hingol